

Northwind Retail Pvt. Ltd. - Employee Handbook

1. Welcome

This Employee Handbook describes the policies, expectations, and benefits that apply to all employees of Northwind Retail Pvt. Ltd. Please read it carefully and reach out to Human Resources with any questions.

2. Working Hours

Standard working hours are 9:30 AM to 6:30 PM, Monday through Friday, with a one-hour lunch break. Employees are expected to be available during core hours of 11:00 AM to 4:00 PM for meetings and collaboration.

3. Attendance Calculation

Attendance is calculated based on biometric check-in and check-out times recorded at the office entrance, or through the mobile app for remote days. An employee is marked 'Present' for a day if they log at least 4 hours of work between 9:00 AM and 8:00 PM. Logging between 4 and 6 hours counts as 'Half Day'. Less than 4 hours, or no log at all without approved leave, is marked as 'Absent'. Monthly attendance percentage is calculated as $(\text{Present days} + 0.5 \times \text{Half Days})$ divided by total working days in the month, multiplied by 100.

4. Remote Work Policy

Employees may work remotely up to 2 days per week with prior manager approval logged in the HR portal. Fully remote arrangements require department head sign-off and are reviewed quarterly.

5. Code of Conduct

All employees are expected to treat colleagues, clients, and vendors with respect and professionalism. Harassment, discrimination, or retaliation of any kind will not be tolerated and should be reported immediately to HR or through the anonymous ethics hotline.

6. IT and Data Security

Employees must use company-issued devices for accessing internal systems, enable full-disk encryption, and never share login credentials. Any lost or stolen device must be reported to IT Security within 24 hours.

7. Expense Reimbursement

Business-related expenses (travel, client meals, approved software subscriptions) are reimbursed within 15 working days of submitting an itemized claim with receipts through the Finance portal. Claims submitted more than 60 days after the expense was incurred will not be reimbursed.

8. Performance Reviews

Formal performance reviews are conducted twice a year, in April and October. Reviews include a self-assessment, manager feedback, and goal-setting for the next cycle. Compensation revisions are typically communicated after the April review.

9. Grievance Redressal

Employees with a workplace grievance should first raise it with their reporting manager. If unresolved within 10 working days, the matter can be escalated to HR, and finally to the Grievance Committee, which meets monthly.

10. Exit Process

Employees resigning must serve a notice period of 60 days for non-managerial roles and 90 days for managerial roles. A full and final settlement, including any pending reimbursements and leave encashment, is processed within 45 days of the last working day.